# Legal Reframing — 2026-05-11 — AXEL

## Core Legal Principle (re: AXEL)

**Slot mechanics are not copyrightable.** Cluster Pays (NetEnt, 2016), cascading reels, multiplier wilds, grid-clear → free spins, RTP math — all have been freely reimplemented across hundreds of slot products and now indie roguelites (CloverPit, Luck Be a Landlord, Slots & Daggers, Slot & Dungeons, Runeborn). **Mechanics: SAFE to clone.**

**What IS protectable:**

- Trademarked names ("Moon Princess", "Trinity", "Play'n GO")
- Visual identity (princesses, anime-Sailor-Moon-adjacent characters, exact symbol art, color palettes that read as Moon Princess)
- Specific audio assets
- The Trinity meter NAME ("Trinity" itself is plausibly fanciful enough for trade-dress risk in a slot context)

## Reframing — AXEL

### Concept 1: AXEL (current working title)

**SOURCE TRACKING:**

- **Original Source:** Moon Princess 100 by Play'n GO (2023+ franchise)
- **Source URL:** https://slotcatalog.com/en/slots/Moon-Princess-100
- **Source Metrics:** Top-tier real-money slot, frequent franchise expansions (Moon Princess Origins 2025, Stargazing 2025, Power of Love 2024, Trinity 2023, original 2017). Signals durable appeal.
- **What We're Copying:** Cluster pays (4+ touching), cascading avalanche on win, multiplier-wild ramp meter that accumulates within a spin, grid-clear → free spins escalation. RTP math pattern.
- **What We're NOT Copying:** Princess characters, anime-magical-girl aesthetic, "Moon Princess" name, "Trinity" meter naming, color palette, audio cues, exact symbol art.
- **Clever Tie-In:** Lean into the *opposite* aesthetic — gritty, grungy, post-arcade — to ride the CloverPit darker-roguelite zeitgeist instead. Marketing language: "the dopamine of a cascading slot, without the casino."
- **Marketing Keywords:** roguelite slot, cascading slot, no-real-money gambling, cluster pays, Balatro-like, CloverPit-like, slot roguelike

**REFRAMING:**

- **Original:** Moon Princess 100 (princess-themed real-money slot)
- **IP Risk:** Direct visual + naming overlap = HIGH if shipped as-is with princesses + "Trinity"
- **Reframed:** AXEL — neutral codename. Theme = abstract/industrial OR thematic biomes (see variations). Multiplier meter renamed (e.g. "Surge meter", "Overload", "Chain Coil").
- **Core Appeal Retained:** Cascading clusters, multiplier escalation, grid-clear payoff, free-spins climax, RTP math
- **Changes Made:** Theme/skin, all naming, visual symbol library, audio
- **Legal Safety: HIGH** (mechanics-only clone, all IP elements replaced)
- **Viral Potential Lost:** None — the share-worthy element is the cascade visual + multiplier, not the princess theme. Princess theme would actually HURT virality vs the CloverPit-grunge zeitgeist.

## Legally Safe Concepts (Ready for Variation)

| # | Safe Concept | Original Source | Legal Safety | Viral Potential |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| 1 | AXEL — cascading-cluster slot roguelite, biome-themed | Moon Princess 100 (mechanics) + Hades (biomes) + CloverPit (run pressure) | HIGH | 8/10 |

## Naming Replacements (mandatory before public release)

| Current AXEL spec term | Risk | Replacement options |
|---|---|---|
| "Trinity meter" | MEDIUM-HIGH (Play'n GO product name in slot context) | "Surge", "Coil", "Overload", "Cascade Charge", "Resonance" |
| "Princess powers" | HIGH (direct theming overlap) | "Operator abilities", "Charm effects", "Sigil powers" (theme-dependent) |
| "Moon Princess 100" references in marketing | HIGH | Reference "cluster cascade slots" generically, or "Balatro-like roguelite slots" |

## Rejected (Cannot Reframe Safely)

None — AXEL's core appeal is mechanical, not IP-bound. Full reframe is achievable with zero loss.